

Νίκανδρος ὁ Κολοφώνιος

Nicander of Colophon on Poisons, Nature, and the Trojan Cycle

eul_aid: lcw

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Nicander of Colophon was a Hellenistic didactic poet of the 2nd century BCE. A citizen of Claros near Colophon, he served as a priest of Apollo at the oracle there, a role attested by Delphic inscriptions. He was active at the court of Attalus III of Pergamum, to whom he likely dedicated a work.

His surviving hexameter poems are the **Theriaca**, on venomous animals and their bites, and the **Alexipharmaca**, on poisons and antidotes. Major lost works include the **Heteroeumena**, a poem on metamorphoses used by Ovid; the **Georgica**, on farming, which influenced Virgil; and the **Melissourgica**, on beekeeping.

Nicander is a key figure in Hellenistic didactic poetry. While his surviving works are more valuable for toxicological folklore than scientific accuracy, his literary influence was profound. His lost **Heteroeumena** and **Georgica** were direct models for Ovid's **Metamorphoses** and Virgil's **Georgics**, respectively.

Works (5)

- [Αλεξιφάρμακα](#) · [Alexipharmaca](#) · 631 passages
- [Ἐπιγράμματα](#) · [Epigrams](#) · 11 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Θαλάσσης καὶ Φύσεως](#) · [Fragments on Sea and Nature](#) · 207 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τοῦ Τρωικοῦ Κύκλου](#) · [Fragments on the Trojan Cycle](#) · 22 passages
- [Θηριακά](#) · [On Wild Animals](#) · 958 passages